



Optum
VA CCN Region 3
3237 Airport Road
La Crosse, WI 54603

May 5, 2026

The Honorable Ashley Moody
Attn: Terri Finger
201 South Orange Avenue
Suite 350
Orlando, FL 32801

Dear Senator Moody:

Thank you for contacting Optum. We appreciate the opportunity to address your follow-up questions regarding Mr. Steven Barden's concerns related to potential Fraud, Waste, and Abuse (FWA), as well as potential quality-of-care (PQI) concerns, related to services provided by Dr. James Green.

As shared in our previous response dated March 30, 2026, Optum takes any potential health care FWA and quality-of-care concerns very seriously. However, Optum is limited in its ability to share information and determinations related to our review and investigations in accordance with 38 C.F.R § 5705.

Please find Optum's responses to your follow-up questions below in **blue**:

1. Response states that "Optum PI [Public Integrity] Department only share its findings with those individuals directly involved in their investigation." Is Veteran Steven Barden, as the apparent originator of the complaints considered "directly involved in their investigation"?

A Veteran who submits a potential fraud tip is not considered directly involved in Optum's Program Integrity Department's investigation. While Optum encourages and relies on Veterans and other stakeholders to report potential fraud concerns, individuals who submit tips do not participate in or have visibility into the investigative process itself.

2. Similarly, "CQ's [Clinical Quality] findings are only shared with those individuals directly involved with the quality review process." Is this Vet in any way involved in the CQ process?

PQI submissions are reviewed internally by Optum's Clinical Quality Team and Veterans are not involved in the review or investigation process.

3. "Optum's Clinical Quality (CQ) Department confirmed receipt of two (2) separate PQI [potential quality of care] Referral Forms related to this concern on March 27, 2024, and September 10, 2024." Is there any way the Vet would be notified if these are the concerns he brought forward? Related to that, there's no way for him to be told whether or not these investigations and reviews are completed?

When a Potential Quality Issue (PQI) Reporting Form is submitted, a confirmation of receipt is not sent to the submitter. Additionally, the outcomes of Clinical Quality reviews are not shared with Veterans. These practices are in accordance with 38 C.F.R. § 5705, which protects confidentiality and limits disclosure to support internal quality improvement activities while maintaining compliance with applicable federal law.



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On behalf of Optum, thank you for the opportunity to address Mr. Barden's concerns. It is an honor and privilege to serve the Veterans and all VA CCN providers in Florida.

Very Respectfully,

Kelly K.
Congressional Inquiry Department
Optum